

# PROCLAMATION

*WHEREAS,* September 20, 2026, marks the 10<sup>th</sup> anniversary of the 26.2 Step Mini Marathon, founded right here in Omaha, Nebraska, and traditionally held on the third Sunday of September, and

*WHEREAS,* This inspiring tradition began when marathon runner and BRCA 1 mutation carrier Denise Ibsen Cole broke her hip after signing up for her third Chicago Marathon, successfully pivoting her passion from miles to steps, and

*WHEREAS,* The 26.2 Step Mini Marathon raises critical awareness for high-risk genetic mutations like BRCA 1, which carries up to an 87% lifetime chance of breast cancer and a 64% chance of ovarian cancer, while honoring and supporting all individuals who have fought cancer, and

*WHEREAS,* Over the past decade, founder Denise Ibsen Cole has served as an Education Ambassador for Bright Pink, educating over 2,000 women on breast and ovarian health; a Patient Advocate Leader for FORCE, driving legislative advocacy; a Board Director for the Hereditary Cancer Foundation; and a dedicated community leader focused on removing healthcare barriers and promoting genetic testing for Nebraskans, and

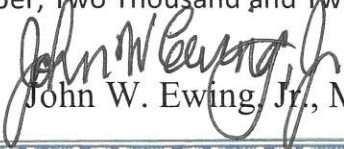
*WHEREAS,* The 26.2 Step Mini Marathon directly impacts our community by raising funds for the Hereditary Cancer Foundation to assist those with high-risk genetic mutations, as well as the Nebraska Medicine Oncology Patient and Family Experience Fund, which provides essential relief such as gas and grocery cards for cancer patients undergoing treatment, and

*WHEREAS,* Citizens will gather at the Omaha Cancer Survivors Park on September 20, 2026, to celebrate ten years of resilience, educations, and community support.

*Now Therefore,* I John Ewing, Mayor of the City of Omaha, do hereby proclaim September 20, 2026 as

## 26.2 STEP MINI MARATHON DAY

*In Witness Whereof,* I have set my hand and caused the official seal of the City of Omaha to be affixed this 1<sup>st</sup> Day of September, Two Thousand and Twenty Six.

  
John W. Ewing, Jr., Mayor of Omaha

